



Usability Top 10

Professor Nathan W. Twyman

Professor T's Usability Top 10

#1:

**Signify
Capability**

1. Signify
Capability

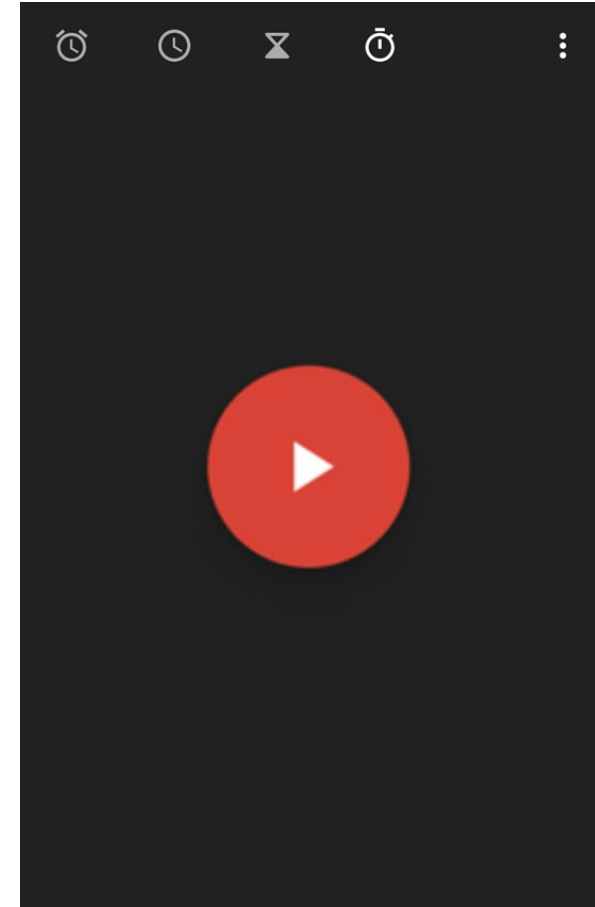
Key Concepts

- Affordances
- Signifiers
 - Overarching, top-level, and minor
 - Clarity
 - Discoverability
 - Just In Time
 - Interference
- Constraints

Usability Top 10

1. Signify Capability

What does this
app do?

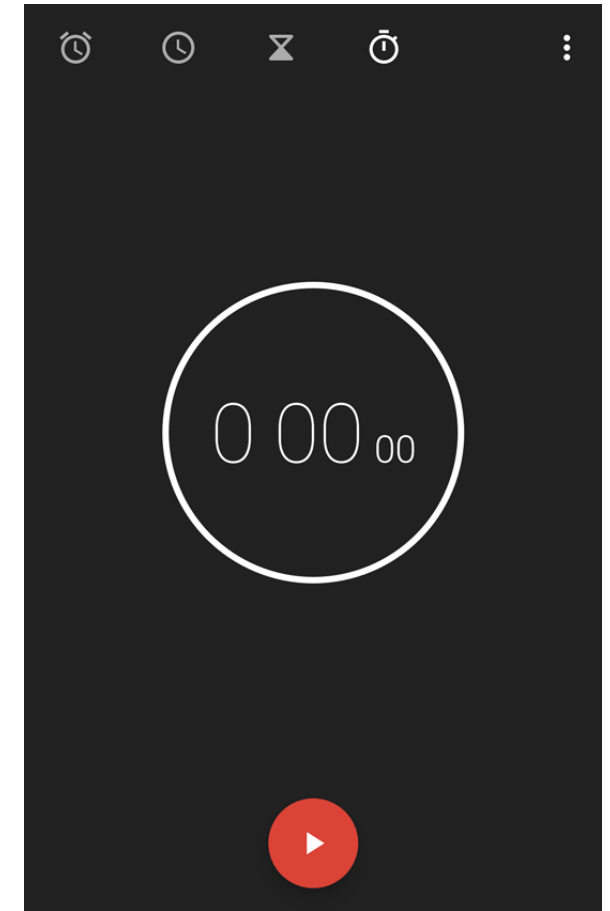
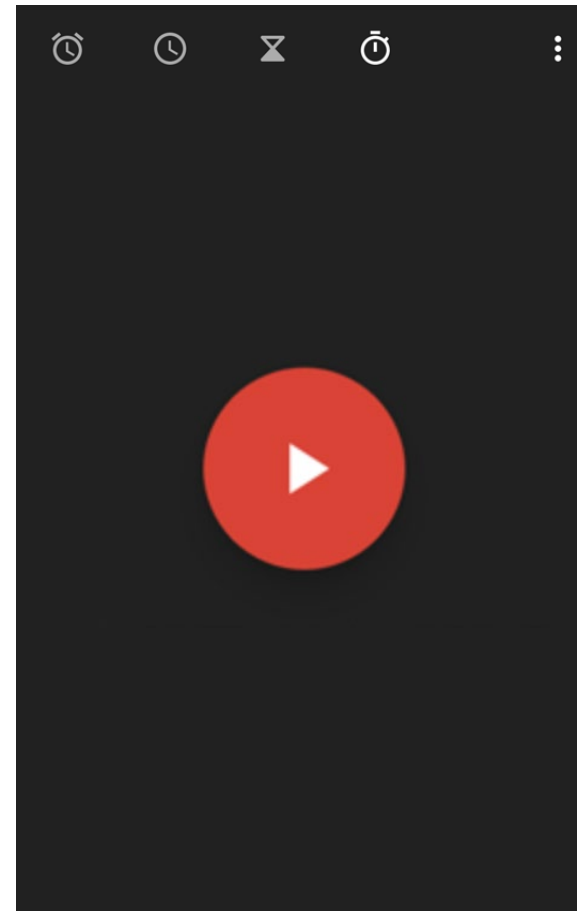


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1. Signify Capability

Signifiers

What does this
app do?

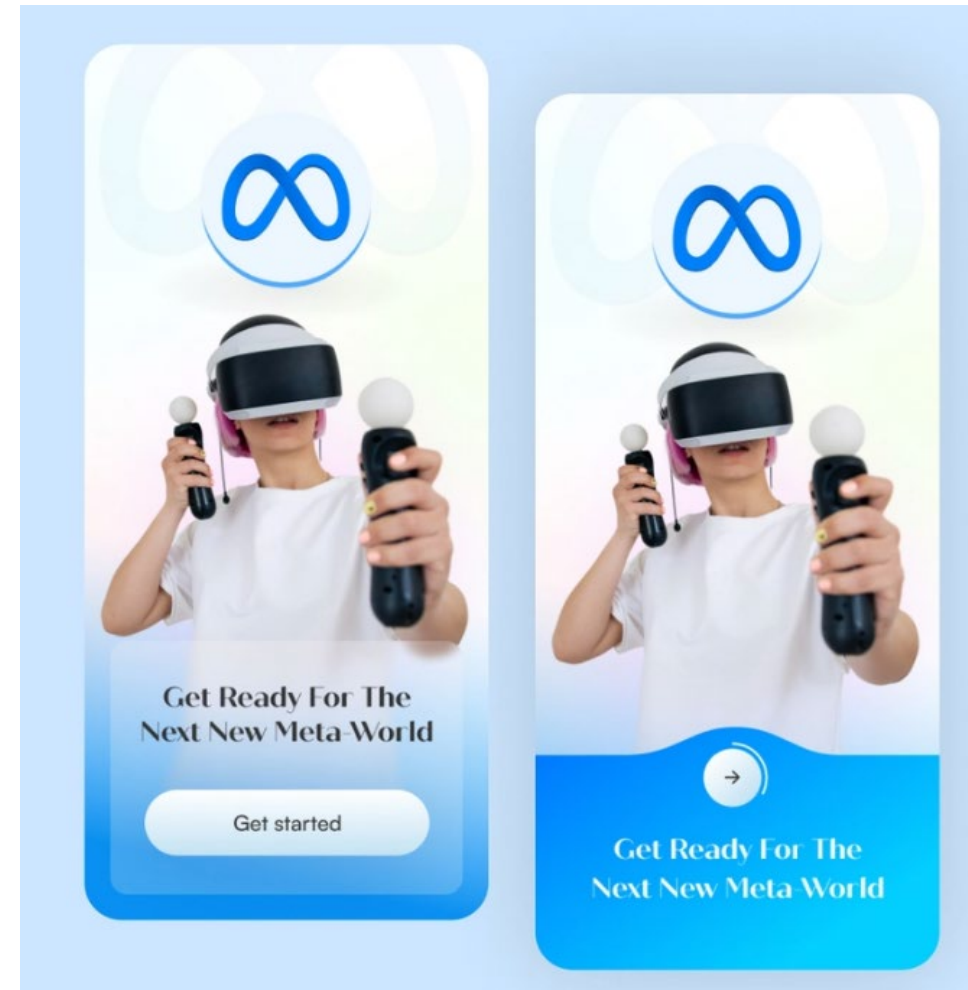


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1. Signify Capability

Signifiers

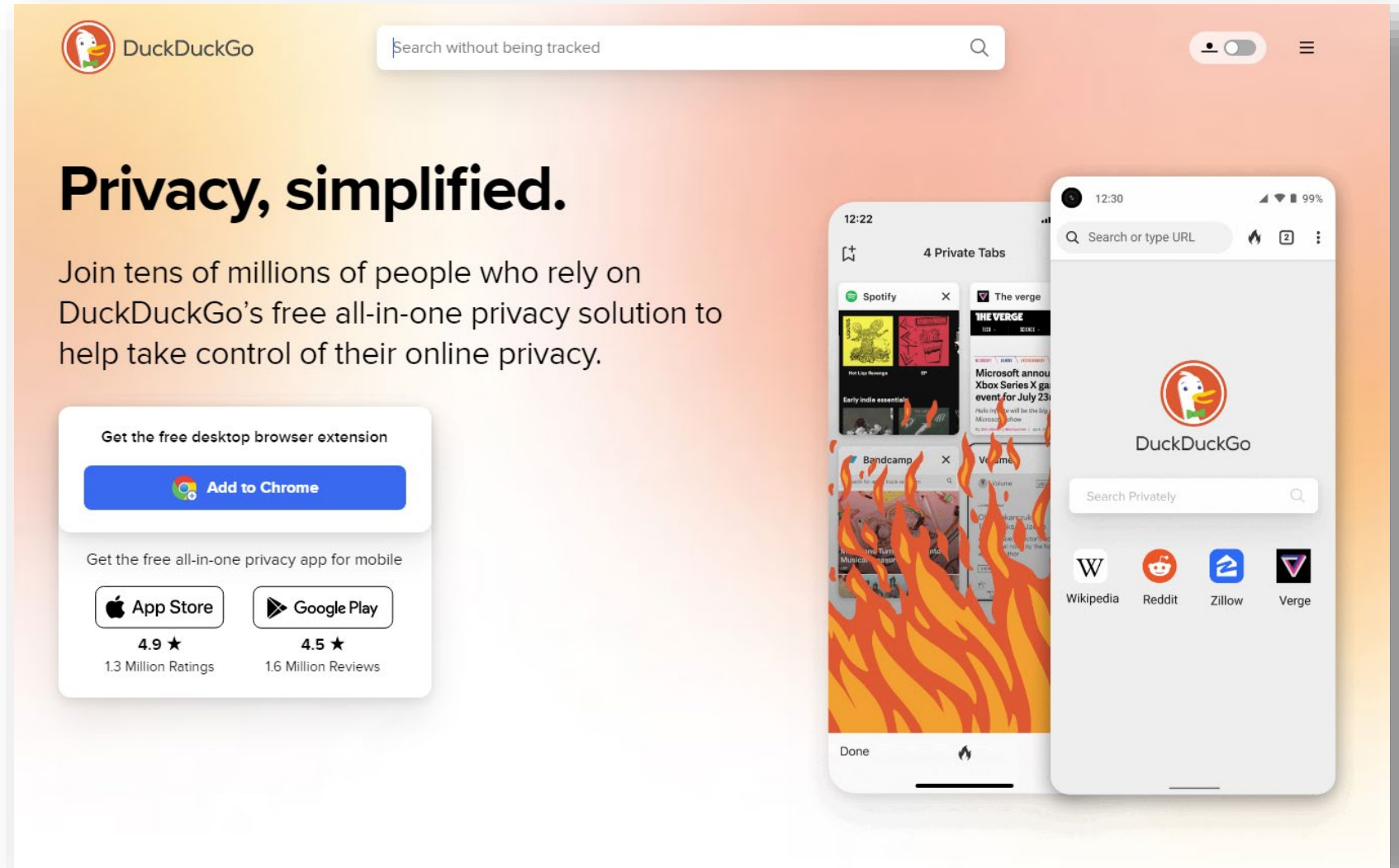
What does this
app do?



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1. Signify Capability

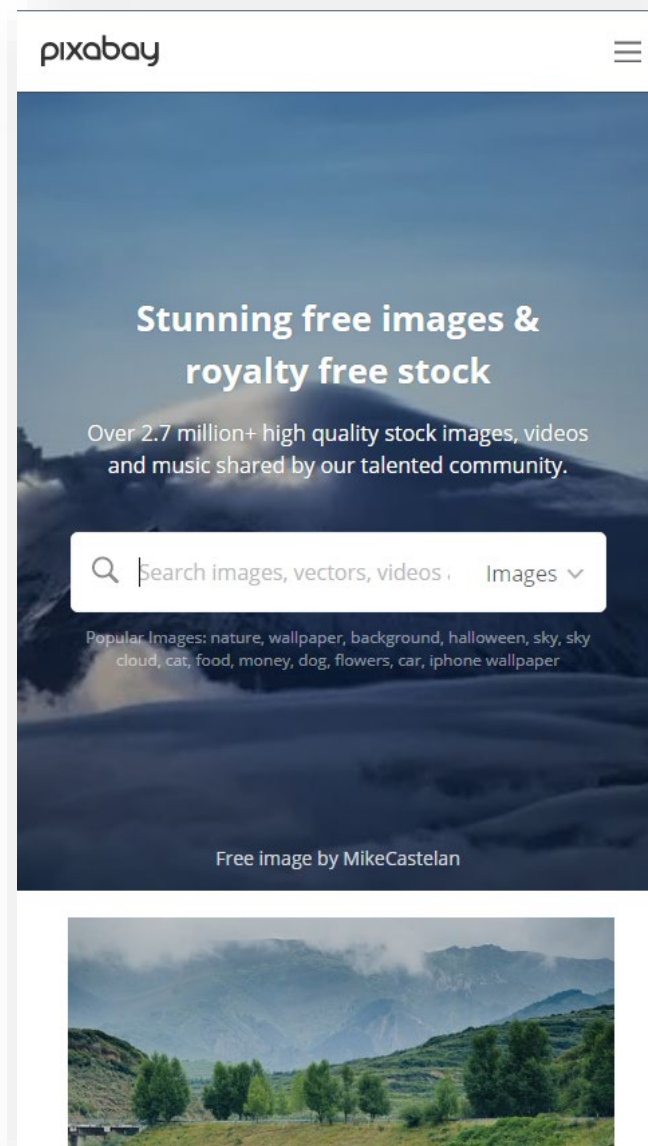
Signifiers



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1. Signify Capability

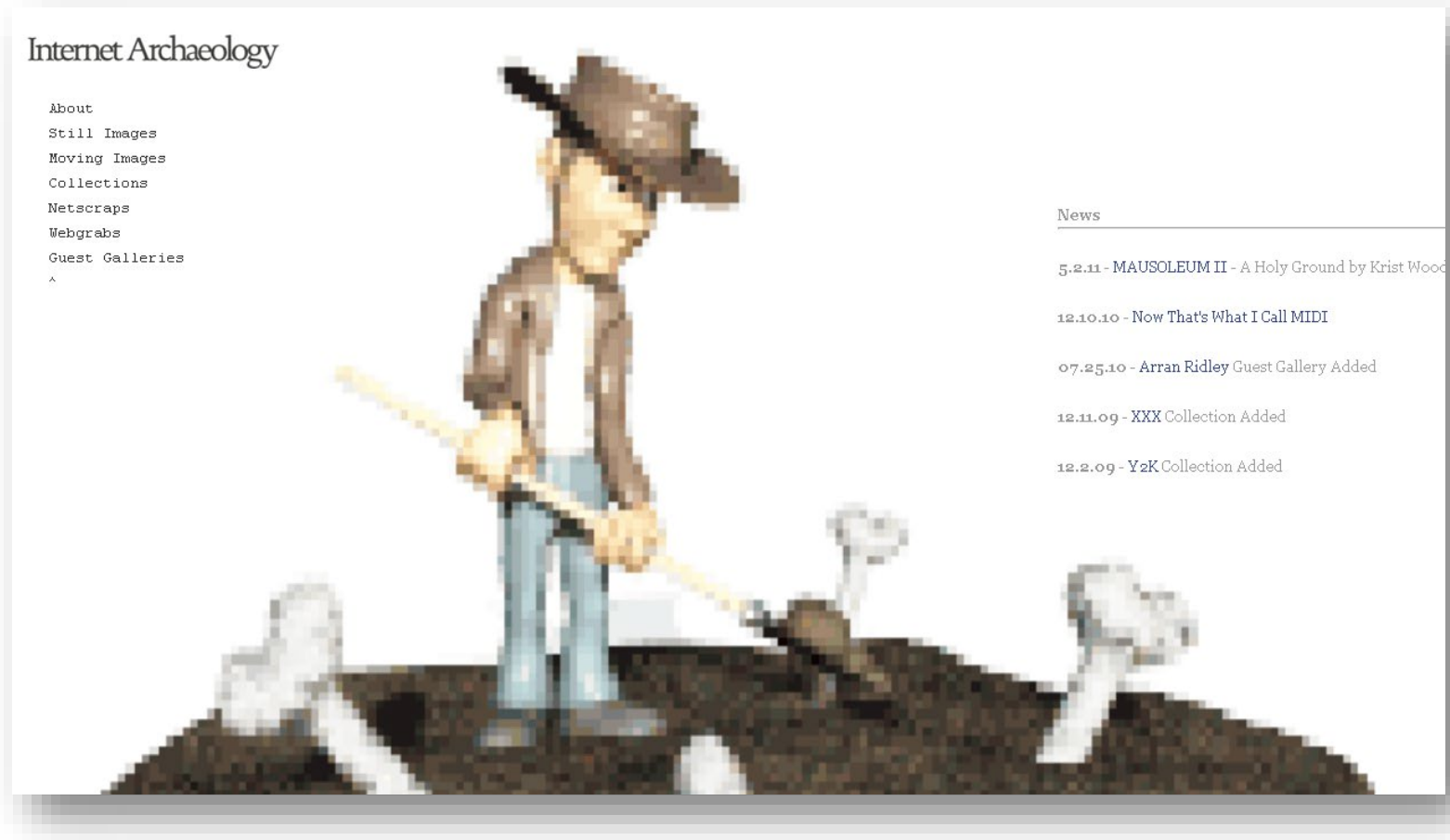
Signifiers



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1. Signify Capability

Signifiers



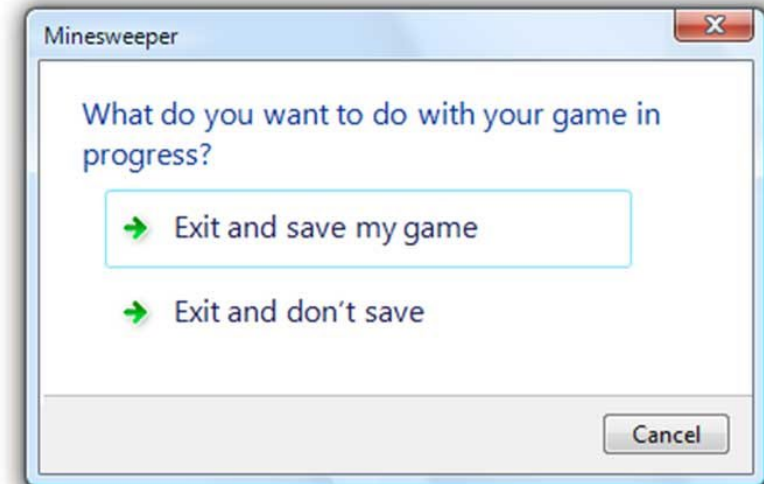
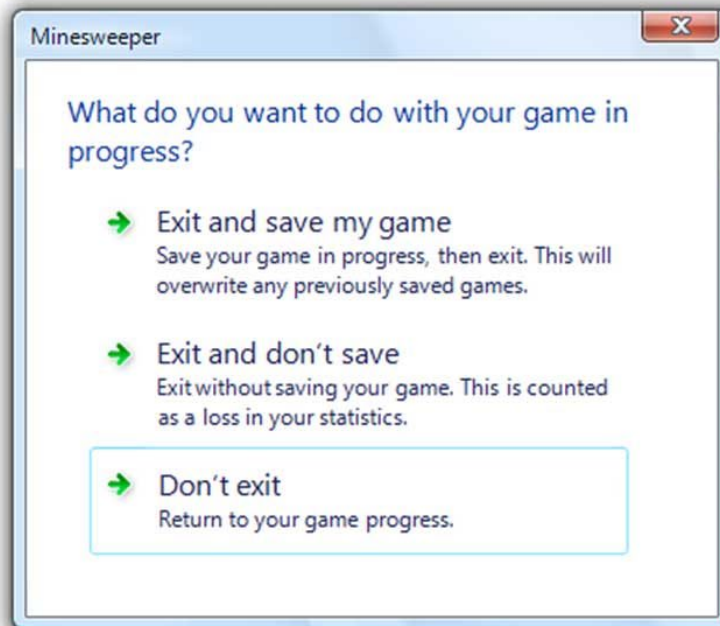
See also: thecloveclub.com

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1. Signify Capability

Signifiers

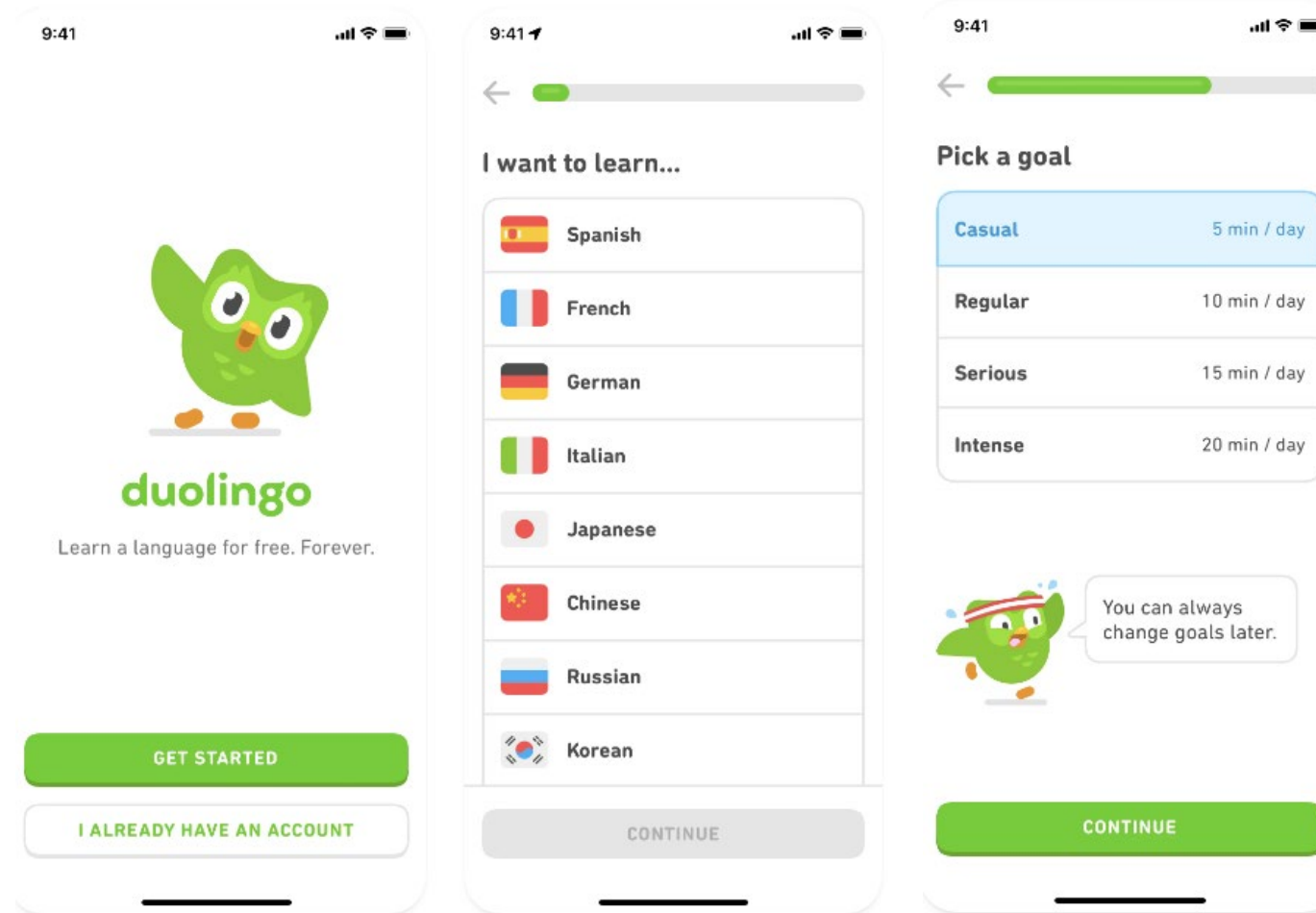
Text Signifiers should
be as succinct as
possible



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1. Signify Capability

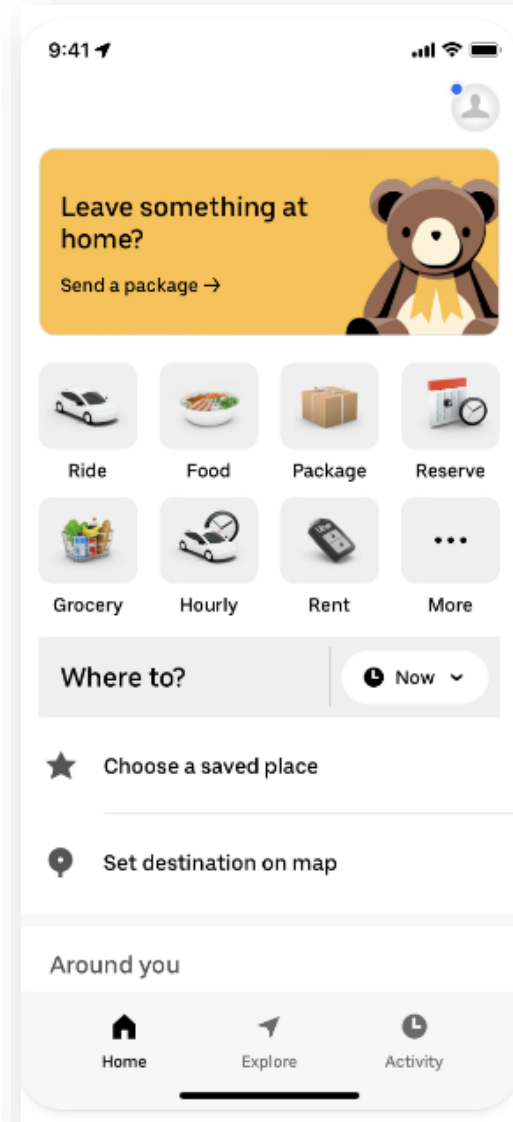
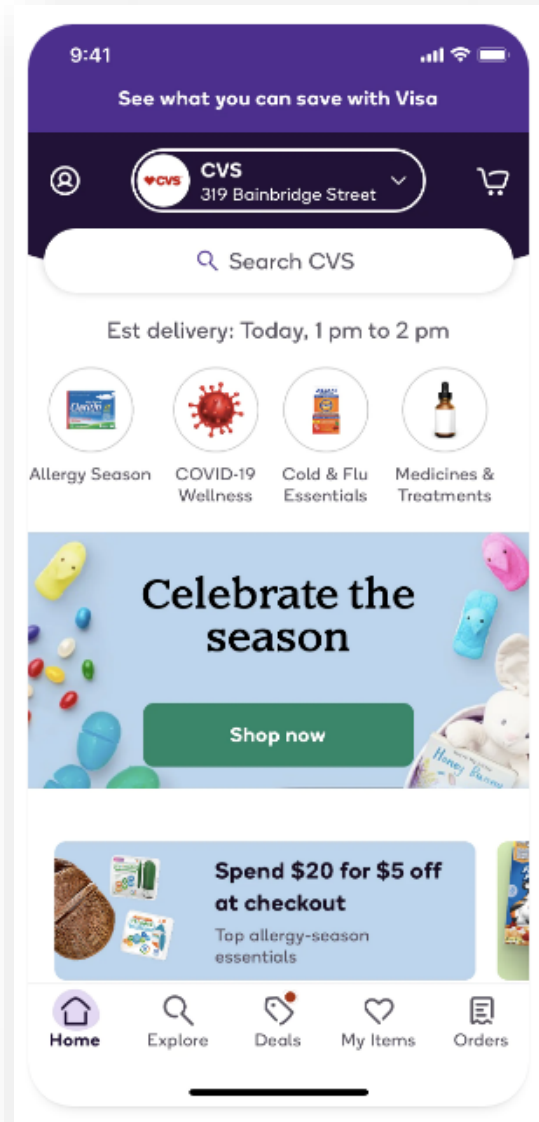
Signifiers for Discoverability



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1. Signify Capability

Signifiers for Discoverability



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1. Signify Capability

Signifiers for Discoverability



“By the way, I have an interesting feature you might like...”



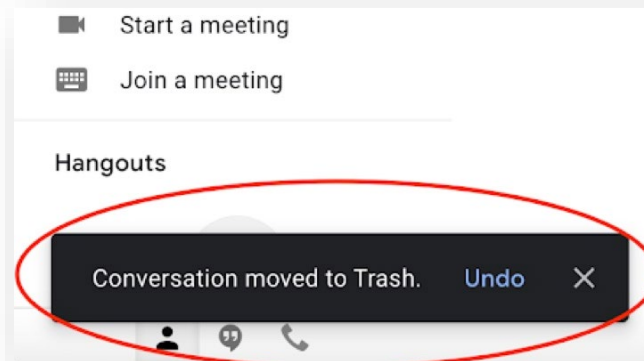
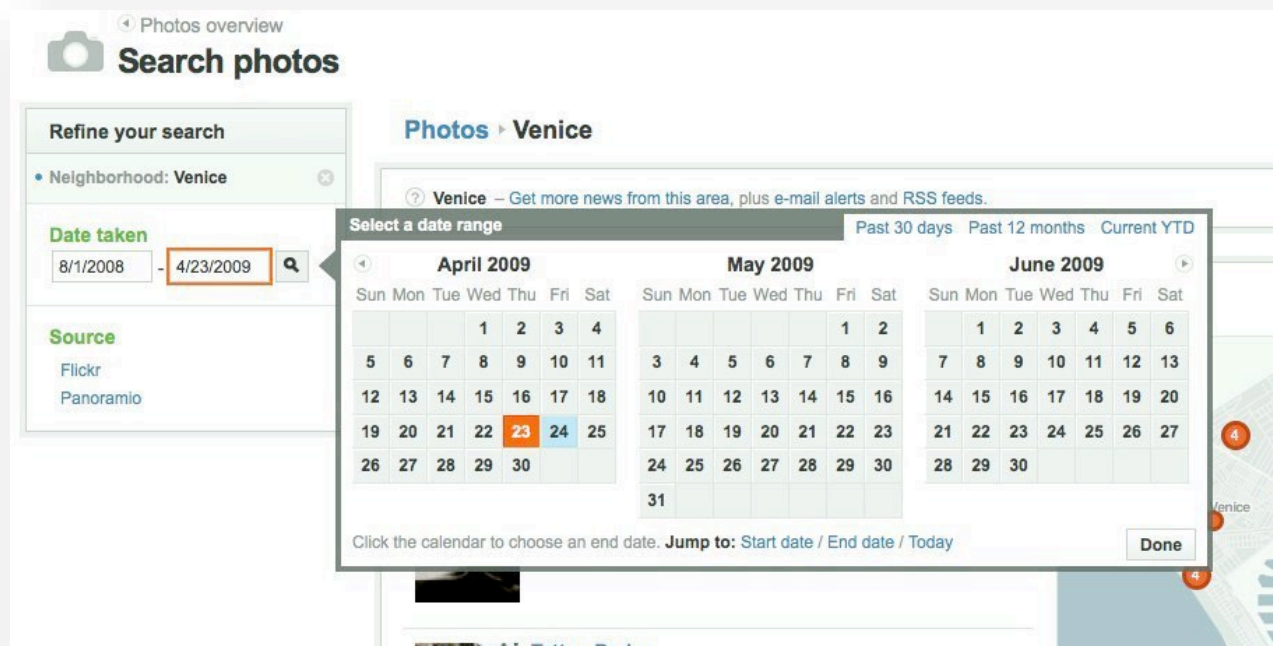
“Alexa, I need a workout.”

“Alexa, I need something to eat.”

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1. Signify Capability

Signify all Affordances



Tags

- toxboe [x]
- rolling [x]
- skate [x]
- inline [x]
- denmark [x]
- copenhagen [x]

ADD

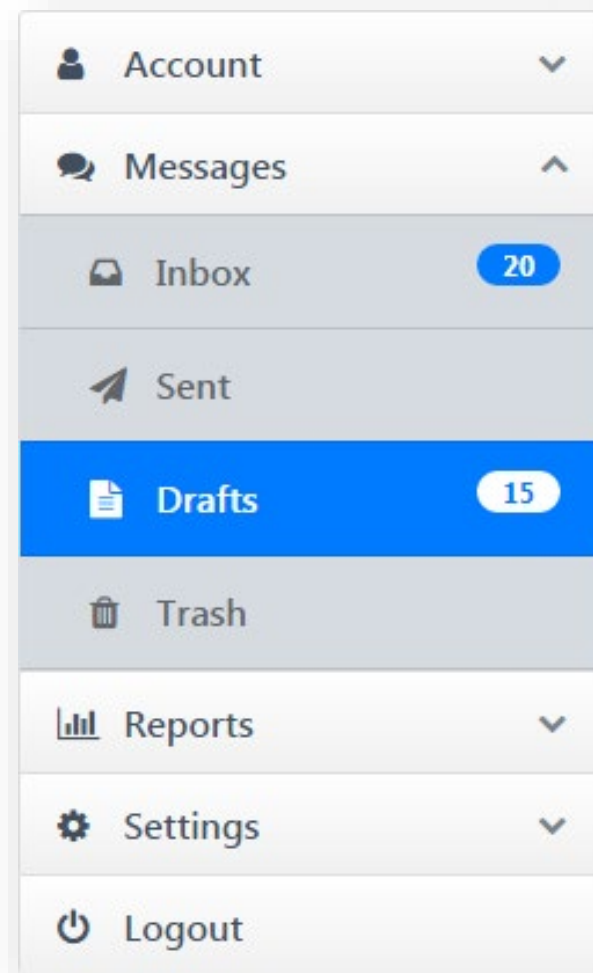
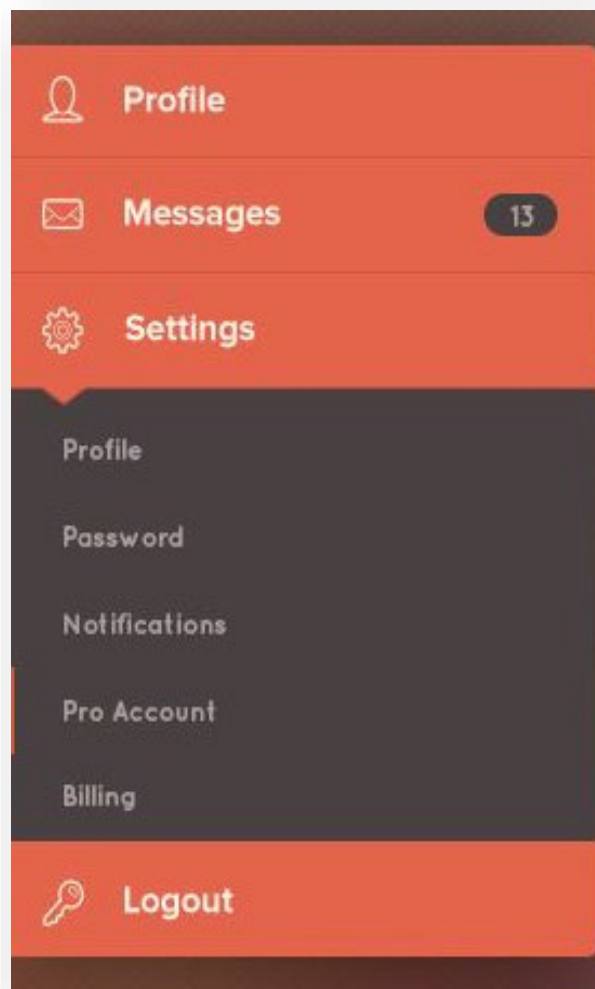
click a tag: [amsterdam](#) [copenhagen](#) [cphdj](#)
[denmark](#) [fisheye](#) [imyta](#) [inline](#) [rolling](#)
[saxophone](#) [skate](#) [toxboe](#)

Separate each tag with a space:
cameraphone urban moblog. Or to join 2
words together in one tag, use double
quotes: "daily commute".

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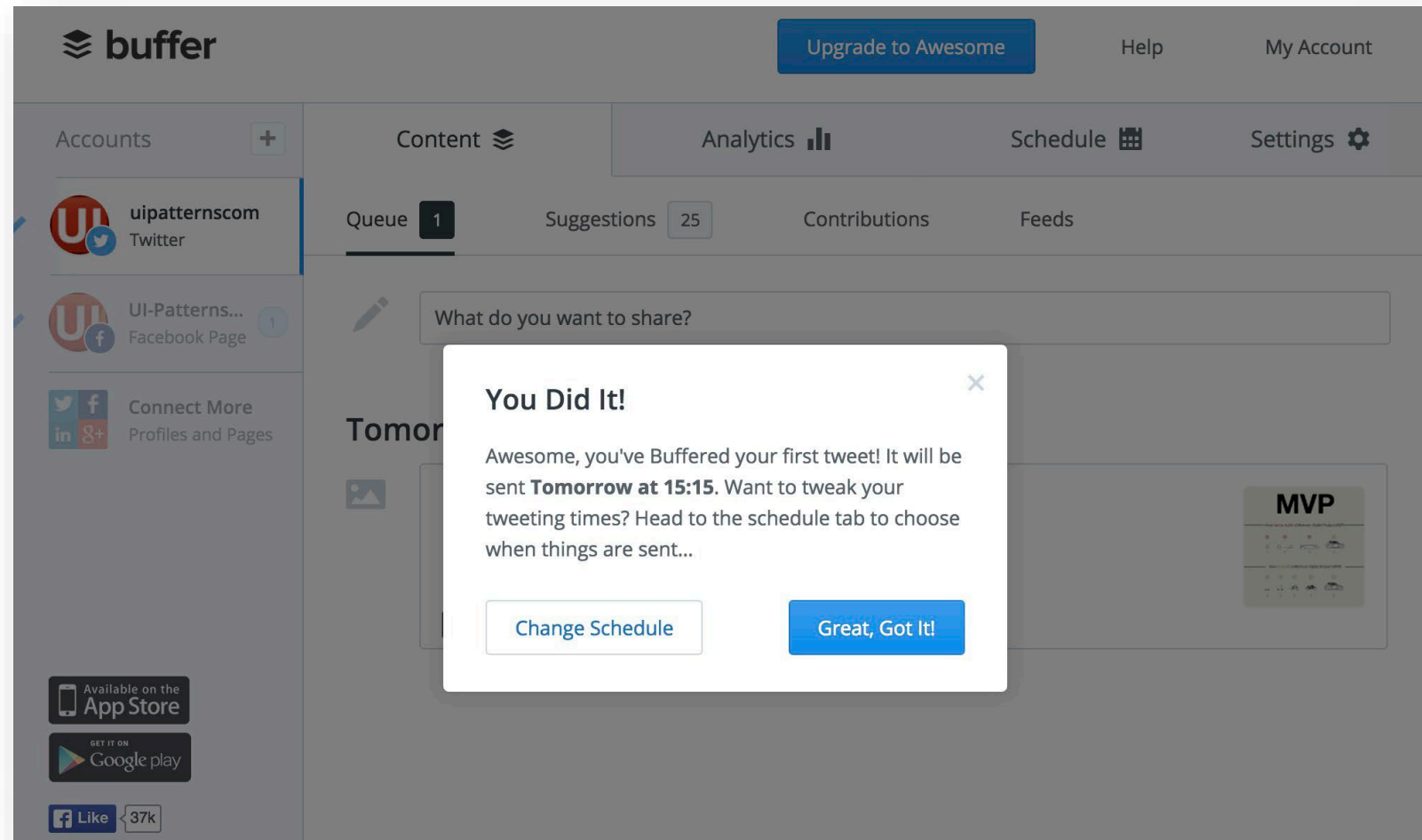
Signifying Affordances



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1. Signify Capability

Signifying Affordances: Just-in-Time



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1. Signify Capability

Signifier Interference

BELIEVE-EAT-OR-NOT RECIPE

BLT Salad with Homemade Croutons



- ✧ 1/2 loaf (about 12 ounces) Trader Joe's Sliced Sourdough Bread
- ✧ 2 Tablespoons Trader Joe's Extra Virgin Olive Oil
- ✧ 1 package (12 oz) Trader Joe's Uncured Apple Smoked Bacon

ANNOUNCEMENTS

- ✧ [RECALL: Potential Undeclared Allergen \(Soy\) in Select Lots of Pita Breads](#)
- ✧ [Cottonwood Heights, Utah - New Store Opening February 6th!](#)
- ✧ [Katy \(Cinco Ranch\), Texas - New Store Opening February 13th!](#)

[View All Announcements >>](#)

DIG IN

Spread The Love



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1. Signify Capability

Signifier Interference

SHOP BY DEPARTMENT



MEN

Hair Support
Mass Gainers
Multivitamins
Pre-Workout Support
Prostate Support
Protein Supplements

Sexual Health
Sports Nutrition
Vitapak® Programs



WOMEN

Beauty Support
Hair, Skin & Nails
Menopause Support
Multivitamins
Pregnancy Support
Sexual Health

Stress Support
Urinary Tract Support
Vitapak® Programs



TEEN

Gummy Vitamins
Multivitamins
Soft Chew Vitamins
Vitapak® Programs



KIDS

Bone Health
Gummy Vitamins
Multivitamins
Soft Chew Vitamins

TOOLS & RESOURCES

[See All GNC Resources](#)

WHAT'S YOUR PROTEIN NUMBER?

USE OUR PROTEIN
CALCULATOR
TO FIND YOURS.

FIND YOURS



GNC VITAMIN GUIDE

USE OUR INTERACTIVE
VITAMIN GUIDE TO FIND
A CUSTOMIZED
SUPPLEMENT PLAN.

FIND YOURS

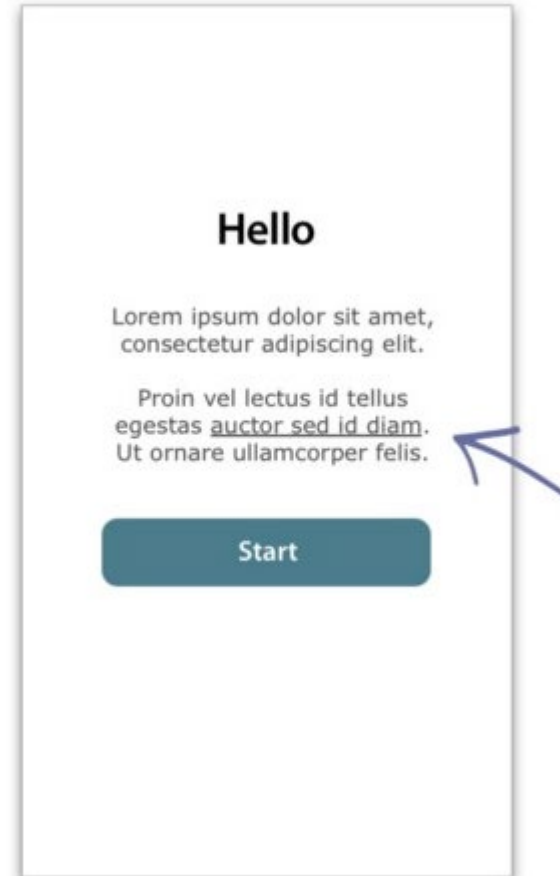


GNC PRODUCT SELECTION TOOLS:

GNC Sports Nutrition Products
GNC Multivitamins
GNC Vitapak® Programs
GNC Fish Oil
GNC Probiotics
[All GNC Product Selection Tools](#)

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Capability

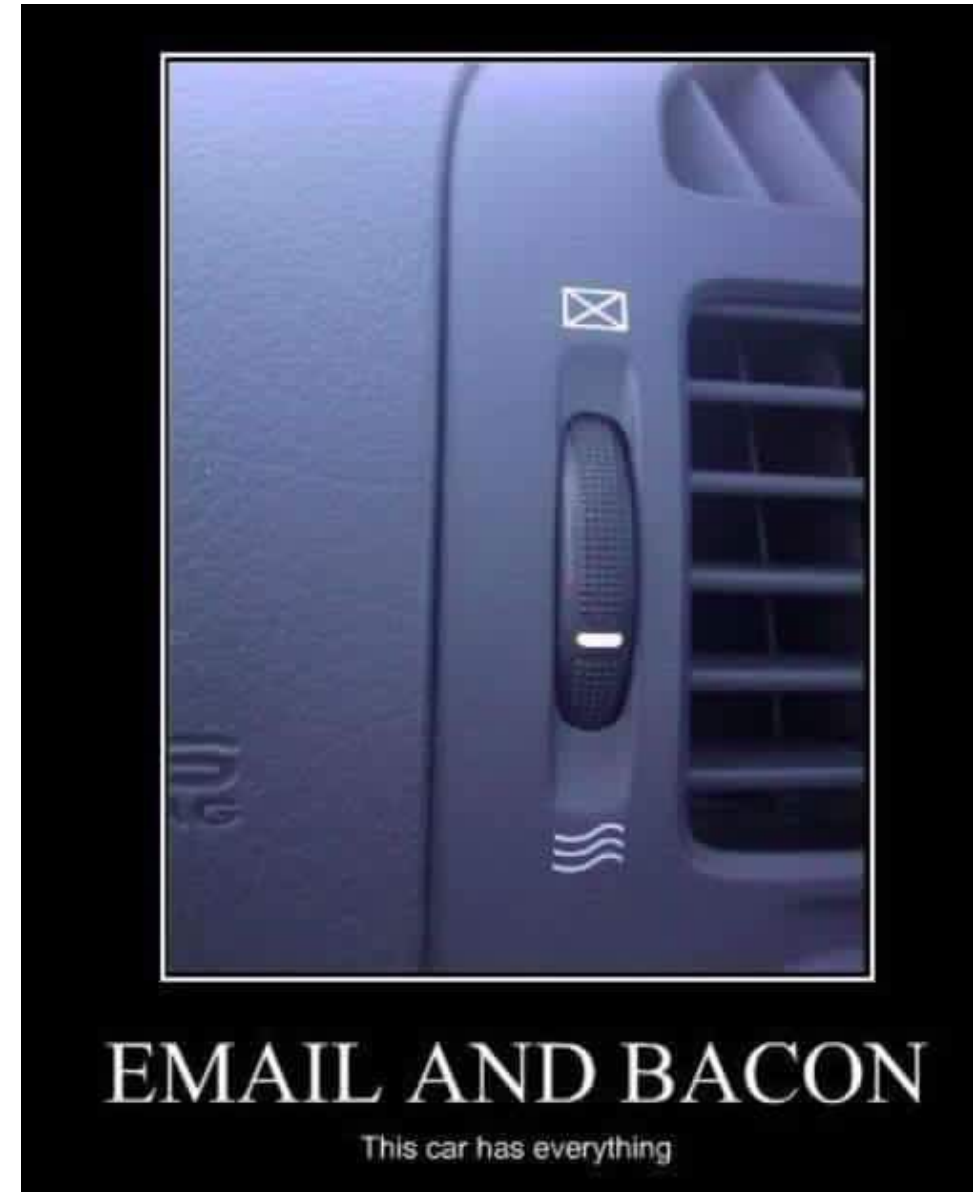
Signifier Interference



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1. Signify
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Signifier Clarity

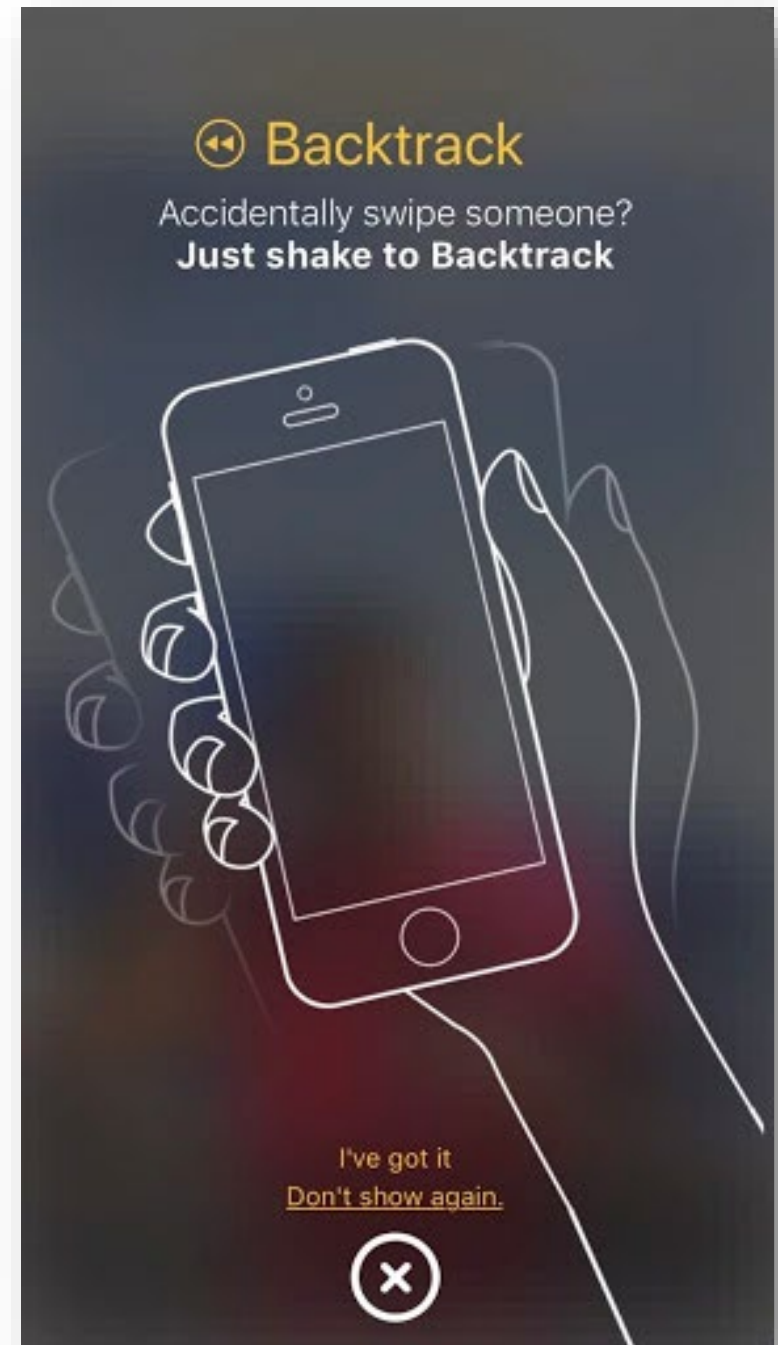


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1. Signify Capability

Signifier Clarity

- Match the user's **mental model**



Usability Top 10

1. Signify Capability

Signifier Clarity

- Match the user's
mental model

Submit

Submit

Submit

blog.textmarks.com › sms-messages-get-cut-off-truncated ▼

Why SMS messages get cut off... and what you can do about it ...

Nov 7, 2017 - When you send the **text** to 41411 like "ALERT MYKEYWORD This is my message here... ", if you include any special characters, then the whole ...

wordpress.org › support › topic › text-is-cut-off ▼

Text is cut off | WordPress.org

One issue I'm having is that the **text** is being **cut off** both left and right. I've attached images above. I'm using it as a widget in the four column footer on the left



What do you need help with?



Cleaning



Handyman



Assistance

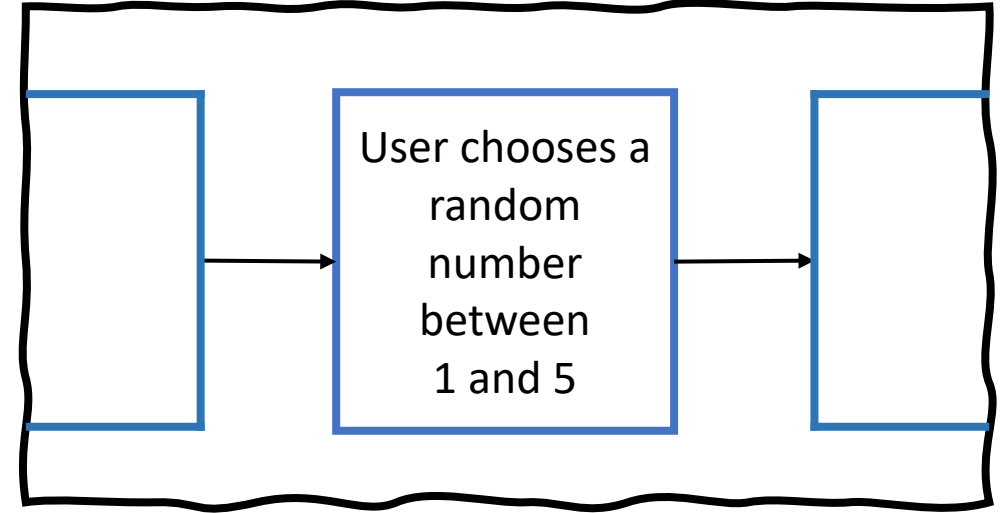


Moving

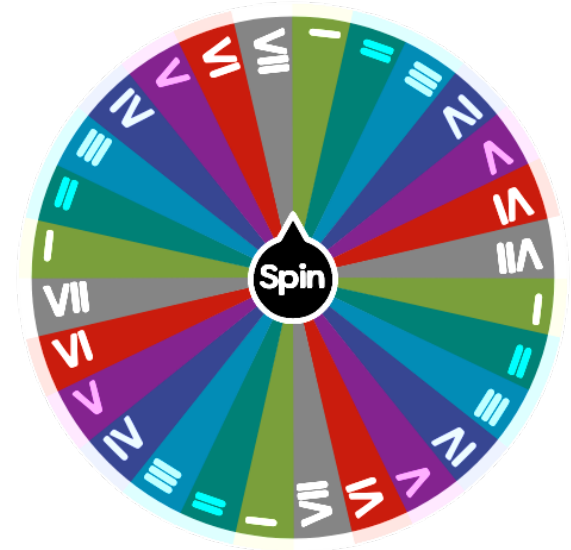
1. Signify
Capability

Signifier Clarity

- Match the user's **mental model**



Roll

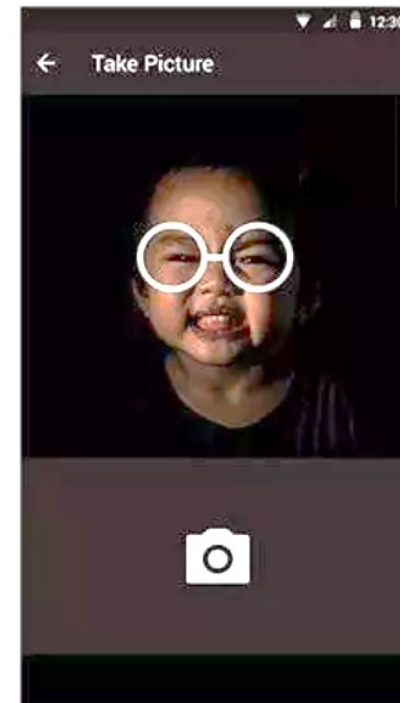
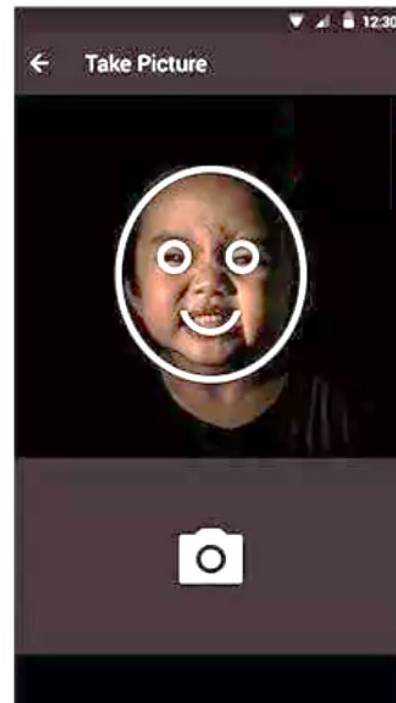
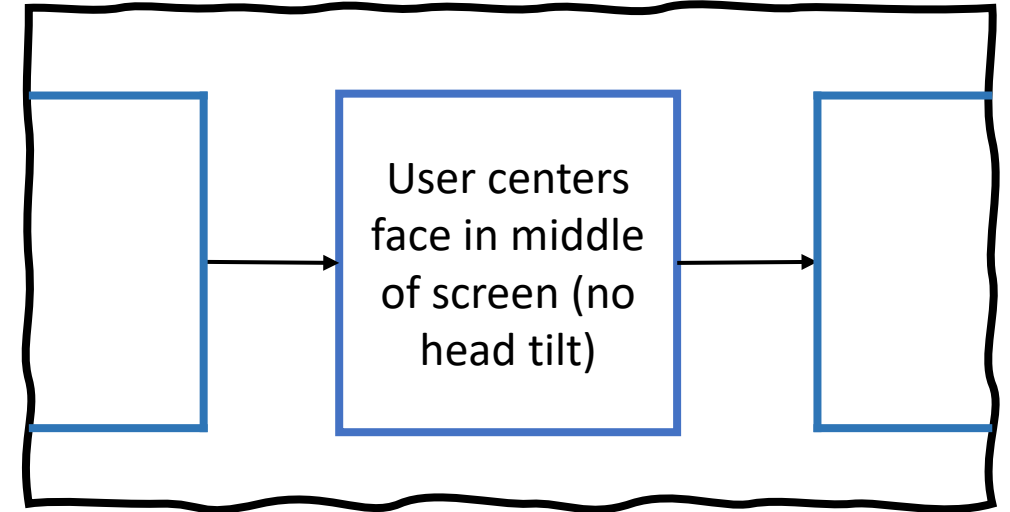


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1. Signify Capability

Signifier Clarity

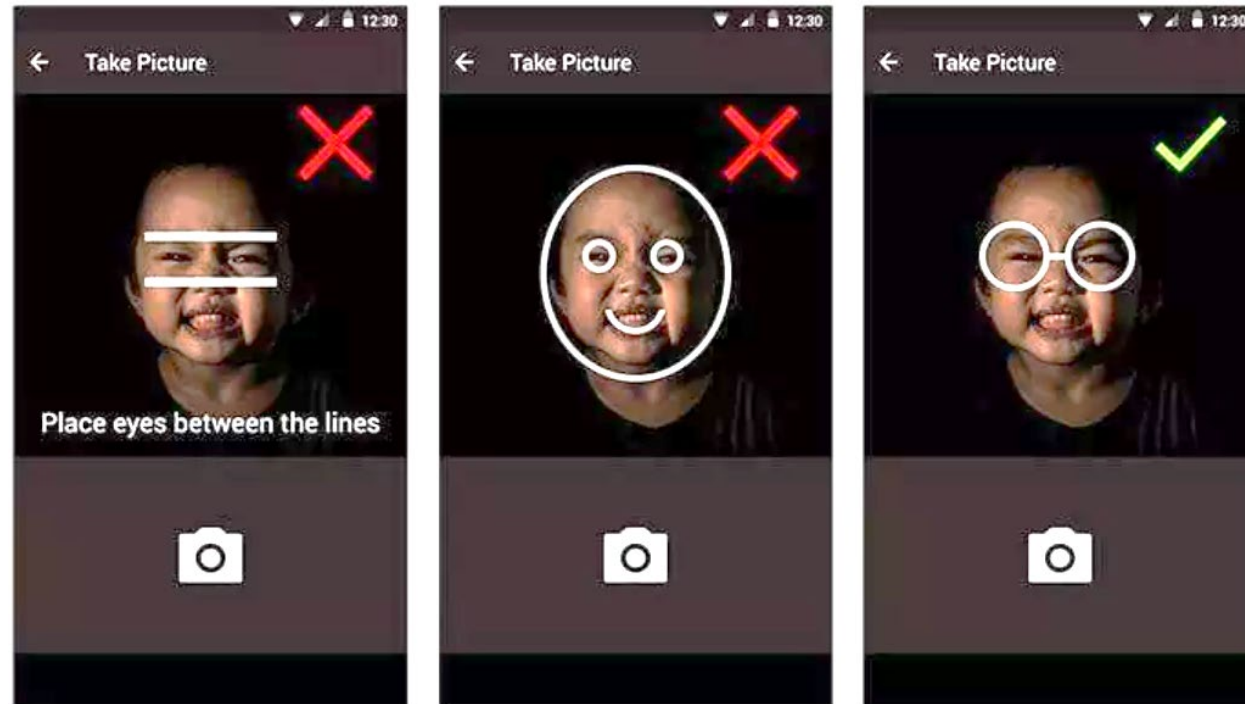
- Match the user's **mental model**



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1. Signify Capability

Signify Constraints



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1. Signify Capability

Manipulate?

nextdoor ×

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+ Strictly Necessary Cookies Always Active

nextdoor ×

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Manage Consent Preferences

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1. Signify Capability

Signify Constraints



Sign in

Email

Password

[Forgot password?](#)

Sign in

A blue arrow points to the 'Sign in' button.



Special page

Create account

Username [\(help me choose\)](#)

ScunthorpeM181

The user name "ScunthorpeM181" [has been blacklisted](#) from creation. Wikipedia [username policy](#) does not allow names that are misleading, promotional, offensive or disruptive. Please select another username that complies with [policy](#), or if you want to seek approval for a username, you can do so by filing a request at [Wikipedia:Request an account](#).

1. Signify
Capability

Recap

1. **Signifiers** are words or symbols that indicate **affordances** (capabilities) to the user.
2. Wherever a user first starts using the system, use strong signifiers to **signify its overarching affordance**.
3. Signify the most important capabilities in a prominent way to **facilitate discoverability**, starting with the Home Page.
4. Be careful to **signify every high- and low-level affordance** and **constraint**, and do it **just in time**, not early.
5. Make signifiers **clear** to the user by being **succinct**, avoiding **interference**, and matching the user's **mental model**.

1. Signify
Capability

Pop Quiz: Signifying Capability

- 1) How is an affordance visually different from a signifier?
- 2) How might you signify the main purpose of an AR application for restaurant menus?
- 3) What signifiers do you see on crumbl's homepage bar?



 FIND A CRUMBL

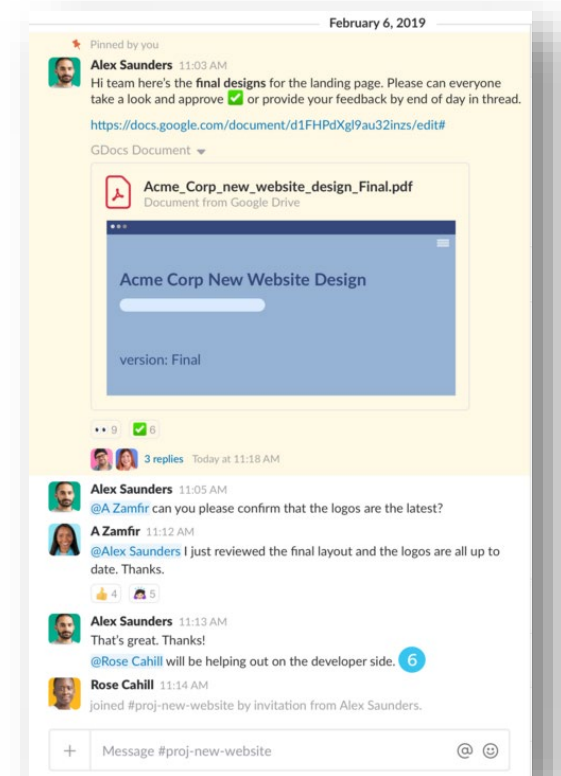
ORDER NOW

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1. Signify Capability

Pop Quiz: Signifying Capability

- 4) Your system allows the user to keep some preferred content always on top or highlighted. How might you signal that capability to the user?





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Professor Nathan W. Twyman